Frederik Godt Hansen | CV

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Current position

Assistant professor (tenure track) — **Odense, Denmark**
Department of Political Science and Public Management — *September 2024-*
University of Southern Denmark

Academic background

Postdoctoral researcher — **Aarhus, Denmark**
Department of Psychology and Behavioral Sciences — *December 2021-August 2024*
Aarhus University

PhD, Political Science — **Aarhus, Denmark**
Department of Political Science — *August 2021*
Aarhus University

MA, Political Science — **Aarhus, Denmark**
Department of Political Science — *2019*
Aarhus University

BA, Political Science — **Aarhus, Denmark**
Department of Political Science — *2016*
Aarhus University

Research statement

My research systematically examines how citizens' encounters with the state shape their trust in public institutions. My primary contribution is to the understanding of the micro-foundations of institutional trust. Specifically, my research demonstrates that institutional trust is shaped by perceptions of outcomes, fair processes, and relations with frontline workers, and politicians' ability to efficiently deliver on promised policy objectives. This research agenda has resulted in a series of publications in leading international journals and established my expertise in institutional trust and causal inference through survey experiments.

Peer-reviewed publications

2026

1. Halling, Aske, Julian Christensen, **Frederik Godt**, & Niels Bjørn Grund Petersen. "Danish unemployment caseworkers do not discriminate against ethnic minorities: evidence from a high-powered survey experiment". Accepted for publication in *Journal of Behavioral Public Administration*.
2. Trillingsgaard, Tea, Hanne Nørr Fentz, and **Frederik Godt Hansen**. "Stepped Care for Couple Distress: Issues of Design and Implementation". Accepted for publication in *Couple and Family*

Psychology: Research and Practice, September 2026.

3. Hansen, **Frederik Godt** & Aske Halling. "Burden Without Backlash? Procedural Fairness and Trust in Response to Welfare Compliance Demands". Conditionally accepted for publication in *Policy Studies Journal*, August 2026.
4. **Godt, Frederik** & Aske Halling. 2026. "Beyond the Hassle: How Favorable Outcomes Reduce the Subjective Experience of Administrative Burden?". *International Public Management Journal*, 1-23. www.doi.org/10.1080/10967494.2026.2696855
5. Trillingsgaard, Tea, Nanna Fensman Lassen, Katherine J. W. Baucom, Laura Tøt Svare, **Frederik Godt Hansen**, and Hanne Nørr Fentz. 2026. "Self-help interventions for parenting couples experiencing conflict or relationship distress: Study protocol for a randomized controlled trial". *Trials*, 27, 117.

2025

6. Fentz, Hanne Nørr, **Frederik Godt Hansen**, and Tea Trillingsgaard. 2025. "Evaluating the OurRelationship Program Among Easy-to-Reach Distressed Couples: A Randomized Pilot Study". *Couple and Family Psychology*. www.dx.doi.org/10.1037/cfp0000297.
7. Trillingsgaard, Tea, **Frederik Godt Hansen**, and Hanne Nørr Fentz. 2025. "Comparing the OurRelationship Program and Bibliotherapy for Parents Experiencing Couple Distress: A Randomized Pilot". *Journal of Marital and Family Therapy*, 51: e12762. www.doi.org/10.1111/jmft.12762.

2024

8. Halling, Aske, Niels Bjørn Grund Petersen, Julian Christensen, and **Frederik Godt Hansen**. 2024. "Deservingness at the Frontline: How Health-Related Responsibility Cues Affect Sanctioning and Prioritization of Citizens". *Public Administration*, 103(1):94-114. doi: www.doi.org/10.1111/padm.13004
9. **Hansen, Frederik Godt**. 2024. "How Government Efficiency Shapes Political Trust: Evidence from the Case of Brexit". *British Journal of Political Science*, 54(3): 957-968. www.doi.org/10.1017/S0007123423000388

2023

10. **Hansen, Frederik Godt**. 2023. "Can Warm Behavior Mitigate the Negative Effect of Unfavorable Governmental Decisions on Citizen Trust?." *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, 10(1): 62-75. www.doi.org/10.1017/XPS.2021.23

2022

11. **Hansen, Frederik Godt**. 2022. "How Impressions of Public Employees' Warmth and Competence Influence Trust in Government." *International Public Management Journal*, 25(6): 939-961. www.doi.org/10.1080/10967494.2021.1963361

2021

12. **Hansen, Frederik Godt**. 2021. "Trust in Governmental Institutions: How Government Performance Matters. (Ph.d. dissertation). *Politica*. www.politica.dk/frederik-godt-hansen

Papers invited for R&R

1. Fentz, Hanne Nørr, **Frederik Godt Hansen**, Brian Doss, and Tea Trillingsgaard. "Stepped Care for Relationship Distress: Effectiveness and Predictors of Treatment Response in Dis-

tressed Parenting Couples". R&R at *Family Process*

Papers under review

1. **Godt, Frederik**, Colt Jensen, Ryan Lafaro & Elizabeth Bell. "Winning Matters: How Electoral Outcomes Shape Perceived Administrative Burden in Voting". Under review at *American Review of Public Administration*
2. Fentz, Hanne Nørr, **Frederik Godt Hansen**, Brian Doss, Lea Tangelev Greve, and Tea Trillingsgaard. "Stepped Care for Relationship Distress and Children's Adjustment: A Multi-Site Effectiveness Study". Under review at *Prevention Science*
3. **Hansen, Frederik Godt**, Hanne Nørr Fentz, Marianne Simonsen, Miriam Wüst, & Tea Trillingsgaard. "How Universal Couple-Focused Prevention During the Transition to Parenthood Impact Family Dissolution". Under review at *Journal of Child and Family Studies*. Also published as a preprint on *PsyArXiv*

Papers in progress

1. **Godt, Frederik**. "Anti-public Servant Bias? Sector-based Differences in Perceptions of Warmth and Competence".
2. **Frederik Godt** and Thorbjørn Sejr Guul. "Trade-off between Representative Bureaucracy and Administrative Burden in Choice of Public Providers". Working Paper.
3. **Godt, Frederik** and Aske Halling. "Systematic review of trust in the public administration". Working paper.
4. Fentz, Hanne Nørr, **Frederik Godt Hansen**, Brian Doss, Tea Trillingsgaard. "Individual Mental Health and Well-being in Parenting Couples Following Stepped Care for Relationship Distress". Working paper.

Conference participation

- DPSA (2017, 2018, 2024, 2025, 2026)
- IRSPM (2025)
- ABCT (2023)
- ESFR (2023)
- EGPA (2019)
- APSA (2019)

Public outreach and dissemination

- Interview for article in *Kristeligt Dagblag*, 04-09-2026
- Research mentioned in Danish national media (DR)
- Junior expert on the Danish version of EUPACK 2024 (with senior expert Thorbjørn Sejr Guul). Collection of data on the Danish public administration and writing bi-monthly memos with updates on ongoing changes in the Danish public administration (e.g., reforms of the public administration).
- Trillingsgaard, Tea, Hanne Nørr Fentz, & Frederik Godt Hansen. 2024. "Styrk Familiens Trivsel, Første Rapport: Midtvejsresultater". Aarhus: Aarhus Universitet.
- Presentation of preliminary results at conference for participating municipalities. March

2024.

Teaching experiences

My teaching is directly informed by and aligned with my research on institutional trust, administrative burden, and survey experiments. At the master's level, I have developed a course on institutional trust, which draws directly on my own research findings and positions research results in a teaching context. I actively integrate insights from my on-going projects into my courses.

Teaching experience

Bachelor-level teaching: Lectures in Public Administration and Organization (2024-2026; SDU), Tutorials and grading of exam papers in Public Administration (2021, AU), Tutorials and oral examination in Policy Evaluation (2020 + 2022; AU), Tutorials in Methods II: Quantitative methods (2018; AU).

Master-level teaching: Lectures in Advanced Applied Quantitative Methods (2026; SDU), Lectures in Political Advice and Evaluation (2025, 2026; SDU), Course responsible for Interacting with 'the System': How the Public Administration Impacts Citizens' Trust (fall + spring 2023; AU, 2025; SDU), Tutorials in Research Methods 4 (2022; AU).

FMOL: Lectures in Organization Theory (2026)

Supervision: 15 bachelor's theses (political science), 7 master's theses (political science), 12 master's theses (FMOL), 5 internships/work placements, 2 elective essays.

Reviewer experience

Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory, Public Administration Review, British Journal of Political Science, TESS - Time-Sharing Experiments for the Social Sciences, British Journal of Politics and International Relations, Aarhus Universitets Forlag, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Public Performance and Management Review, Governance, Public Administration, Public Management Review, International Review of Administrative Sciences, Journal of Experimental Political Science, Journal of Social Policy.

Grants

Alongside an early-career focus on publications, I have gained experience developing funding applications as partner to Trygfonden (March 2026), as CO-PI for an application to DFF (June 2026), and as leader of a work package for an application to DFF (October 2026).

I have secured the following grants as PI for research articles:

- "Building greater trust in government: the significance of warm and friendly employees", Grant from Department of Political Science, Aarhus University. 2021 (DKK 35,000).
- Obtained funding for housing at Bikubenfonden Academic Guest House in New York City (for a research stay abroad which was eventually cancelled due to Covid-19)
- "Restoring public trust in government", AUFF grant (supplementary pool). 2018 (DKK 60,000).

Awards

- Teacher of the year at Department of Political Science and Public Management, University of Southern Denmark. 2025. Nominated for the faculty award for Teacher of the Year award at the Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Southern Denmark.
- Nominated for the 2020 prize paper of the Danish Society for Survey Research